

Gabriel Jacob Perin

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Research Interests

I am broadly interested in **Large Language Models (LLMs)**, **Geometric Deep Learning (GDL)**, and **AI for Science (AI4Science)**. My research interests include efficient, interpretable, safe, and robust machine learning methods, with applications in scientific domains such as astronomy, materials science, and healthcare.

Education

MS University of São Paulo, Computer Science March 2026–December 2027 (Expected)

- Advisors: Prof. Nina S. T. Hirata (IME-USP), Dr. André Araujo (Google DeepMind).

BS University of São Paulo, Computer Science March 2021–December 2025

- GPA: 9.2/10
- **Coursework:** Machine Learning, Optimization, Algorithms, Discrete Mathematics.
- **Thesis:** An Introduction to Geometric Deep Learning on Sets, Graphs, and Grids.

Research Experience

University of São Paulo, Graduate Research Assistant SP, BR

- Advisors: Prof. Nina S. T. Hirata and Dr. André Araujo. March 2026–Present
- Researching efficient and training-free methods for controlling LLMs, with applications to post-training interventions and model behavior editing.

IBM Research, Research Intern SP, BR

- Manager: Dr. Mathias Steiner. November 2024–November 2025
- Worked on machine-learning interatomic potentials (MLIPs) and foundation models for materials science.

University of Texas at Austin, Research Intern TX, USA

- Advisor: Prof. Zhangyang “Atlas” Wang. April–July 2024
- Researched model merging methods for Large Language Models (LLMs).
- Investigated the robustness of safety alignment under benign and malicious fine-tuning.
- Collaborated with the group remotely (May 2023–April 2025) in addition to the official research visit (April–July 2024).

University of São Paulo, Undergraduate Research Assistant SP, BR

- Advisor: Prof. Nina S. T. Hirata. February 2022–April 2025
- Developed machine learning models (Random Forests, CNNs, and self-supervised methods) for classifying astronomical objects in the S-PLUS survey, co-advised by Prof. Claudia L. M. de Oliveira.
- Designed few-shot retinal disease classification pipelines using meta-learning algorithms (Reptile) with CNN and Vision Transformer backbones.

Teaching Experience

University of São Paulo, Teaching Assistant

SP, BR

- Advisor: Prof. Nina S. T. Hirata.
- Course: Introduction to Machine Learning (undergraduate).
- Held office hours and provided detailed feedback on assignments.

March 2025–June 2025

Publications and Preprints

Training-Free Task Vectors for LLM Behavioral Control 2026

G. Jacob Perin, L. Boscaini, A. Araujo, N. S. T. Hirata

Neurips 2026

Equivariant Interatomic Potentials without Tensor Products 2026

T. Reschützegger, S. Aykent, **G. Jacob Perin**, B. H. Nunes, F. Cipcigan, R. N. B. Ferreira, M. Steiner, F. L. Thiemann
Preprint

Meta-Learning based Few-Shot Classification of Retinal Diseases 2026

G. Jacob Perin, D. J. C. Alves, L. M. S. Sousa, E. M. de Elias, N. S. T. Hirata

Journal of the Brazilian Computer Society (JBSCS)

LAD-VF: LLM-Automatic Differentiation Enables Fine-Tuning-Free Robot Planning from Formal Methods Feedback 2026

Y. Yang, J. Hong, **G. Jacob Perin**, Z. Fan, L. Yin, Z. Wang, U. Topcu

ICRA 2026

LoX: Low-Rank Extrapolation Robustifies LLM Safety Against Fine-tuning 2025

G. Jacob Perin, R. Chen, X. Chen, N. S. T. Hirata, Z. Wang, J. Hong

COLM 2025

Extracting and understanding the superficial knowledge in alignment 2025

R. Chen, **Gabriel Jacob Perin**, X. Chen, X. Chen, Y. Han, N. S. T. Hirata, J. Hong, B. Kailkhura

NAACL 2025

Few-shot Retinal Disease Classification on the Brazilian Multilabel Ophthalmological Dataset 2024

G. Jacob Perin, Nina S. T. Hirata

SIBGRAPI 2024

RankMean: Module-Level Importance Score for Merging Fine-tuned LLM Models 2024

G. Jacob Perin, X. Chen, S. Liu, B. Kailkhura, Z. Wang, B. Gallagher

ACL 2024 Findings (short paper)

The Fourth S-PLUS Data Release: 12-filter photometry covering 3000 square degrees in the Southern Hemisphere 2024

F. R. Herpich, ..., **G. Jacob Perin**, et al.

Astronomy and Astrophysics (A&A)

Combinação de Dados Tabulares e Imagens para a Classificação de Objetos Astronômicos 2023

G. Jacob Perin, L. Nakazono, C. Mendes de Oliveira, N. S. T. Hirata

SIBGRAPI 2023, Workshop of Undergraduate Works (WUW)

Awards and Grants

Honorable Mention, IME-USP Graduation Ceremony, University of São Paulo, 2026. Awarded for outstanding academic performance among the graduating class.

FAPESP Master's Fellowship, April 2026–February 2028

CAPES Master's Fellowship, March 2026

FAPESP International Fellowship for Research Experience for Undergraduates (BEPE), April–July 2024

Highlight of the Intermediate Phase, International Symposium of Scientific and Technological Initiation of the University of São Paulo (SIICUSP), 2023

FAPESP Scholarship for Research Experience for Undergraduates, October 2022–November 2024

Event Presentations

LAD-VF: LLM-Automatic Differentiation Enables Fine-Tuning-Free Robot Planning from Formal Methods Feedback 2026

Y. Yang, J. Hong, **G. Jacob Perin**, Z. Fan, L. Yin, Z. Wang, U. Topcu
Poster, ICRA 2026

LoX: Low-Rank Extrapolation Robustifies LLM Safety Against Fine-tuning 2025

G. Jacob Perin, R. Chen, X. Chen, N. S. T. Hirata, Z. Wang, J. Hong
Poster, COLM 2025

Few-shot Retinal Disease Classification on the Brazilian Multilabel Ophthalmological Dataset 2024

G. Jacob Perin, N. S. T. Hirata
Oral, SIBGRAPI 2024

RankMean: Module-Level Importance Score for Merging Fine-tuned LLM Models 2024

G. Jacob Perin, X. Chen, S. Liu, B. Kailkhura, Z. Wang, B. Gallagher
Poster, ACL 2024 (digital)

Combinação de Dados Tabulares e Imagens para a Classificação de Objetos Astronômicos 2023

G. Jacob Perin, L. Nakazono, C. Mendes de Oliveira, N. S. T. Hirata
Poster, SIBGRAPI/WUW 2023 & SIICUSP 2023

Others

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Founding member, L.E.A.R.N., machine learning group advised by Prof. Nina S. T. Hirata

Technical Skills: Python (PyTorch, PyTorch Lightning, TensorFlow, Pandas, Scikit-learn), C++, Git, Bash, SQL